

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-26T19:30:54+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/26/relay-market/#atom-everything>

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An Inside Look at the Relay Market Powering Token Resellers and Fraud

by Matt Lenhard into the market that has grown up around reselling LLM tokens at a discount by pooling API keys from various sources. This looks to be mostly a thing in China. Resellers sell access to an LLM proxy that offers significant discounts on regular API pricing, which they achieve by abusing free trials, proxying through unprotected support bots, or sometimes through stolen credit cards or chargeback attacks. The software they are using for these proxies is open source - mostly one-api and its more actively developed fork new-api , both legitimate API proxy products which can be used to load. balance requests across a pool of API credentials. The buyers are seeking cheap tokens, avoiding geo-restrictions, and in some cases collecting data for model distillation. I've been cautious about exposing my own LLM-driven applications publicly out of fear of abuse leading to big token bills. The existence of this marketplace makes me even more cautious: there's now an entire ecosystem that can profit from finding a new unprotected endpoint to exploit. LLM vendors really need to get bett...

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-25T16:21:00Z

Link: <https://www.apple.com/newsroom/2026/07/apple-map>

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Apple Newsro

Ford's upcoming Universal Electric Vehicle (UEV) Platform through Apple's new MapKit for Automotive SDK. Coming to Ford's UEV Platform in 2027, this integration will deliver a beautiful and easy-to-use navigation experience powered by Apple Maps directly to the vehicle's displays. Road-level Maps information will also enable Ford's Latitude AI team to build a seamless hands-free driving experience. See also: Techmeme's roundup of commentary . ?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-25T16:06:52Z

Link: <https://www.nytimes.com/2026/07/24/well/measles-rec>

d article code=1.0VA.4jBf.vgAYN4Bwu807

Teddy Rosenbluth, reporting for The New York Times

and Prevention announced that there have been 2,318 confirmed cases of measles so far this year. The case count toppled the record set last year , when measles infected more than 2,200 Americans and killed two unvaccinated children . More measles cases have been reported in the United States in the last two years than in all the years from 2000 through 2024 combined.

Reversing course on measles would require a nationwide push to improve vaccination rates, a prospect that experts said seemed unlikely under the leadership of Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. He has halted funding for vaccine hesitancy research , downplayed the risks of measles and spearheaded a hunt for evidence that vaccines are unsafe . Nilay Patel, endorsing Kamala Harris for president in 2024: ? A Vote for Donald Trump Is a Vote for School Shootings and Measles ?. (He missed ? quagmire war with Iran ?.) ?artlontarlton? on Reddit last year: ? Stupid-Americans are the New Irish-Americans, Trump is Their JFK ?. I continue to think about this post frequently . Isaac Asimov, in a column for Newsweek in 1980 : There is...

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-0

Link: <https://birc.app/>

For a long time the b

it's been sunset by the author. Not to fear, however. Fredrik Blank just launched bIRC: Creating an IRC client in 2026 is not something that will pay the bills :) It would be just

for the joy of programming. But the amount of work involved always made me throw the thought aside. But one night when I had nothing better to do, I started implementing the good old spec in Swift (RFC 2812). And then I got motivated to continue, adding IRCv3 extensions and UI. Been working on it on and off on it since the end of 2025. Now I feel pretty satisfied with the result. Say hi to bIRC ? an IRCv3 client for Mac. I was never a big IRC user, personally, and haven't used IRC in years. But I installed bIRC just because it looks so good, and took it for a brief test drive. It's nice. And it is very Mac-assed in a modern way. It's got a detailed documentation page too. There are (alas) many great apps that lack good documentation, but there are very few apps with good documentation that aren't great apps. bIRC is free to download and use from the App Store, and there's a suite of additional fun/pro features...

5. Why \$550 Million Medical Debt only Cost \$5.5 Million

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Sun, 26 Jul 2026 19:03:04 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/byte-size/550-million-only-cost-5-million>

A couple weeks ago, the CEO of Snap was all over the news in the US because he and his wife made a large donation. The weird part about it was that every news outlet that covered it had an acrobatic title where they didn't specifically say how much they donated, yet insisted on that \$550 Million amount. When you read the article a bit deeper, you can do the math. They donated one hundredth of that amount. So I wondered, why did they inflate the amount in the first place? It looked like a PR stunt. This past couple weeks, I worked on a video to explain what really happened and how we should take this news. Enjoy

6. Permutation roots

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 26 Jul 2026 20:32:02 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/07/26/permutation-roots/>

Let σ be a permutation on n elements. If there is a permutation τ such that applying τ twice has the same effect on the list of elements as applying σ once, we say $\sigma = \tau^2$ and τ is a square root of σ . If we let our n elements be the integers $0 \dots [n-1]$ The post Permutation roots first appeared on John D. Cook .

7. exp_q

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 26 Jul 2026 18:20:36 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/07/26/exp-q/>

The function $\text{exp}_q(x)$ is defined by taking the power series for $\exp(x)$ and keeping only the terms whose index is a multiple of q . For example, $\text{exp}_2(x)$ keeps only the even-numbered terms in the exponential power series and so equals $\cosh(x)$. In general, The first sum uses Iverson's bracket notation: a Boolean expression in brackets $[?]$ The post exp_q first appeared on John D. Cook .

8. Book Review: Dungeon Crawler Carl by Matt Dinniman ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Sun, 26 Jul 2026 11:34:33 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/07/book-review-dungeon-crawler-carl-by-matt-dinniman/>

To call this derivative is an understatement. But that's what this genre demands; rehash all your favourite media properties into something new. It's the literary equivalent of having your Transformers' fight your He-Man' toys. The plot, such as it is, features the Vagon Constructor Fleet destroying Earth due to a late beurecratic appeal, forcing people to play The Hunger Games, while a Twitch ?

9. Weekly Update 514: This Week in Data Breaches

Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Sun, 26 Jul 2026 09:14:51 GMT

Link: <https://www.troyhunt.com/weekly-update-514/>

The Origin Energy breach down here in Aus is all over the news this week, and as with many breaches, it's multi-faceted. You've got them leading with "don't worry, your credit card is fine", the hacker leading with "they didn't

